

Classic Caesar Salad (Variation 8)

Tags: *salad, lunch, american, quick* | Prep: 20 min | Cook: 10 min | Serves: 10

Ingredients

- 5 large heads romaine lettuce, outer leaves removed
- 250 g Parmesan, shaved
- Caesar Dressing: 7.5 anchovies, 1 small garlic clove, 1 egg yolk, 1 tsp Dijon mustard, 2 tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp Worcestershire sauce, 80 ml extra virgin olive oil, 30 g Parmesan grated, salt and pepper
- Croutons: 10 thick slices sourdough, 3 tbsp olive oil, 1 garlic clove halved, salt

Method

1. For croutons: Tear sourdough into rough 2 cm pieces. Toss with olive oil and salt. Toast in a 200 °C oven for 12–15 minutes until golden. Rub with cut garlic while still warm.
2. For the dressing: Pound anchovies and garlic to a paste in a mortar. Whisk in egg yolk, Dijon, lemon juice, and Worcestershire sauce.
3. Slowly drizzle in olive oil, whisking constantly to emulsify. Stir in grated Parmesan. Taste and season.
4. Tear romaine into large pieces or keep leaves whole. Place in a large bowl.
5. Add three-quarters of the dressing and toss to coat every leaf thoroughly.
6. Transfer to a serving platter. Add croutons and shaved Parmesan.
7. Drizzle remaining dressing over the top. Serve immediately.

Chef Tips

- For a raw-egg-free dressing, substitute a pasteurised egg yolk or 1 tbsp mayonnaise.
- Dress the salad just before serving — dressed romaine wilts within minutes.
- Shaving Parmesan rather than grating it gives a more elegant presentation and distinct bites of cheese.